Lyons, M. J. (2026).
JAFFE Fact Sheet. Zenodo.
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JAFFE Fact Sheet

Paglen's claims compared with the JAFFE documentation

A quick-reference comparison based on the JAFFE documentation and the later rebuttal essays.

Paglen's claim	What JAFFE documentation actually says
JAFFE was built as an emotion-recognition dataset.	JAFFE was created to study facial-expression perception, not to train an emotion-recognition system.
JAFFE depicts the emotions of Japanese women.	JAFFE consists of images of facial expressions posed by volunteers, accompanied by graded observer ratings; it does not claim to reveal felt emotion or inner state.
JAFFE treats emotion categories as fixed natural kinds.	JAFFE uses expression prompts for posers, and provides graded multidimensional ratings while noting that the expressions are admixtures rather than pure states.
JAFFE assumes a stable mapping from facial expression to inner state.	JAFFE contains images of posed facial expressions; graded observer ratings vary across images and posers; the dataset itself shows variability and cultural specificity.
JAFFE's limitations justify unrestricted artistic reuse.	JAFFE was distributed for non-commercial scientific research under a specific consent framework; public exhibition and redistribution exceed the original scope.
Summary: Trevor Paglen's critique inflates a limited operational framework into broad claims about emotion that JAFFE's documentation does not support.	

Sources

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